

SAMPLE DELIVERABLE — DEMONSTRATION DATA

Competitor Teardown

Three-Competitor Comparison Format · Niche: Online CE / Certification Training (US)
Prepared as a portfolio sample · Format: Basic tier (expanded)

1. Purpose & Method

This teardown answers one question: **where is the attackable weakness among the three dominant players?** Each competitor is assessed across six lenses: positioning, offer & pricing, funnel & acquisition, evidence of traction, moat, and vulnerability. Evidence standard: observable signals only (ad activity, review velocity, content cadence, traffic estimates) — never founder revenue claims. All figures herein are illustrative placeholders demonstrating format.

2. Competitor 1 — "The Incumbent Platform"

Lens	Assessment
Positioning	Category-default brand; "the safe choice" for licensing-board CE credits.
Offer & pricing	Subscription \$39/mo or \$299/yr unlimited; corporate seats at volume discount.
Funnel & acquisition	SEO-dominant (ranks for most "[profession] CE requirements" queries); webinar funnel for corporate; long-running paid search (observable ad persistence = profitable).
Evidence of traction	High review volume across 3rd-party platforms; hiring for sales roles (public job posts); multi-year ad continuity.
Moat	Board accreditations + SEO moat built over a decade.
Vulnerability	Product stagnation: review-sentiment skews "outdated content, clunky UX." Users stay for accreditation, not love. A modern-UX challenger with equal accreditation can peel the under-40 cohort.

3. Competitor 2 — "The Personality-Led Challenger"

Lens	Assessment
Positioning	Charismatic founder brand; "CE that doesn't put you to sleep."
Offer & pricing	Premium cohort course \$497; alumni community \$29/mo. Higher ARPU, lower volume.
Funnel & acquisition	Podcast guest circuit + YouTube channel + Meta ads (active, 8+ months continuity observed) → quiz funnel → email sequence.
Evidence of traction	Fast-growing community (observable member counts); high engagement rates; consistent launch sell-outs claimed with visible waitlists.
Moat	Founder personality + community gravity.
Vulnerability	Key-person risk and scale ceiling: the product IS the founder. Corporate/enterprise buyers won't purchase a personality. B2B lane is wide open next to them.

4. Competitor 3 — "The Quiet B2B Supplier"

Lens	Assessment
Positioning	White-label CE content supplier to employers and associations.
Offer & pricing	Per-seat licensing, opaque pricing ("contact us"); multi-year contracts.
Funnel & acquisition	Direct outbound + conference presence; almost no public marketing footprint.
Evidence of traction	Association partnership announcements; staff growth on LinkedIn; renewals implied by multi-year partner logos.
Moat	Contractual lock-in + procurement relationships.
Vulnerability	Invisible to end-users: zero brand equity with the actual learners. Any learner-loved product entering B2B can displace them at renewal on engagement metrics.

5. Comparative Matrix

Dimension	Incumbent	Personality-led	Quiet B2B
Buyer	Individual + corporate	Individual	Corporate only
ARPU	Low	High	Medium (contract)
Acquisition engine	SEO + paid search	Content + paid social	Outbound + events
User love	Weak	Strong	Unknown/weak
Accreditation strength	Strong	Moderate	Strong
Scale ceiling	High	Founder-capped	High

6. Where the Opening Is

The unoccupied quadrant: a product with the Incumbent's accreditation depth and the Challenger's learner experience, sold to the Quiet Supplier's corporate buyers on engagement metrics. No current player holds two of those three assets, let alone all three. Entry sequence: win individual learners with UX (Challenger's playbook, minus key-person risk via instructor bench), accumulate engagement data, then take that data into corporate renewal cycles against the Quiet Supplier.

— End of sample. Live teardowns include traffic estimates with sources, ad-library evidence screenshots, funnel mapping, and a data appendix. —